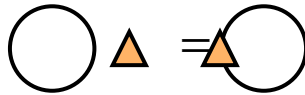


SPROLL 07

Same Picture, Different Story



what a picture keeps, and what it lets go

The Sproll Curriculum · Cycle I: Pops

The Sproll Curriculum

Cycle I — Pops: Things, Differences, and Counting

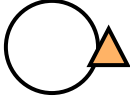
Sproll 07 of 40 · follows Sproll 06: Look Through a Rule

[Illustration: the two ledger strips from Sproll 02, one above the other, circle-then-triangle and triangle-then-circle]



Remember these two histories?

[Illustration: the single shared final picture from Sproll 02, circle and triangle together]

 Rule: just show what's there.

Both histories Collapse to this.

[Illustration: the same two ledger strips again, this time drawn clearly different from each other, order visible]



Rule: keep the order.

Now they Collapse to two different things.

[Illustration: no new image; a simple side-by-side reminder of the shared final picture and the two distinct ledger strips]

 Same picture.

Different story.
It depends on the rule.

[Illustration: the two identical-looking dots from Sproll 00, placed far apart on the page again – one near the top left, one near the bottom right]



● Do you remember these two?

[Illustration: the same two dots, now shown side by side and equal in size, as if compared directly]

● ● Rule: ignore where things are.

They Collapse to: the same.

[Illustration: the same two dots, restored to their original far-apart positions]



● Rule: keep track of where things

are.

They Collapse to: different.

[Illustration: the two dots once more, small, calm, with two small labels beneath, one reading same, one reading different, neither crossed out]

● ● Neither rule is the real answer.

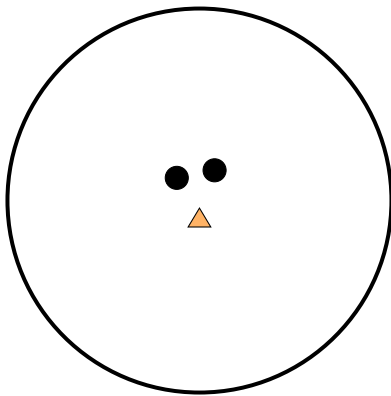
Each rule answers its own question.

[Illustration: a small callback image: the very first page of Sproll 00, the single dot, faded and small in a corner]

● Sproll 00 asked: are they the same?

Now you know: it depends on the rule.

[Illustration: the boundary-scene group from Sproll 00, the small cluster inside a circle, shown once more]



The same is true here.

One thing, or many, depending on your rule.

[Illustration: a simple pair of shapes with a very deliberate, thoughtful pause – no new content, letting the previous two answers sit side by side]

● ● A picture is a kind of answer.

A rule is the question it answers.

[Illustration: two piles or boxes, unlabeled, with a small collection of shapes waiting to be sorted, as if a new kind of rule is about to be introduced]

 Some rules sort everything

into just two piles: same, or not.

— turn the page for Sproll 08: When Are They Equal? —

A Note for Grown-Ups

This book returns to two questions this curriculum deliberately left unresolved earlier: Sproll 02's "which happened first, if the picture can't say," and Sproll 00's "are these two things the same." Both are now answered precisely using Collapse, introduced in Sproll 06: whether two things are "the same" or "different," or whether an order can be recovered, is always relative to the rule used to observe them, never a fact about the underlying history in isolation.

This is stated as directly as the earlier books were careful not to. The point of leaving Sproll 00 and Sproll 02 open was precisely so that this resolution would land as an answer to a question the child already holds, rather than as an isolated new fact with nothing to attach to.

Sproll 08: When Are They Equal? continues directly from this book's final page.